LEMON NIGHT

BATONROUGE ALTERNATIVE

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Lemon Night is a diy publishing and promotion company and a source for booking, distribution, and other creative services.

by: LEMON NIGHT

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What is a zine?

A zine (rhymes with "bean" and short for "magazine") is a short collection of images and text, usually from multiple artists or writers. Zines are typically self-published, relying on do-it-yourself means and philosophy and tend to focus on cultural phenomenona interesting to the publisher.

This zine is called Baton Rouge Alternative and it features work from local writers and artists, a few blurbs about recent releases, interviews with art or music related businesses, and a story about the history of the arts culture in Baton Rouge.

three encapsulations

i.

since i was born, i've been
told the answer to all good
secrets is vitamins, that i'm

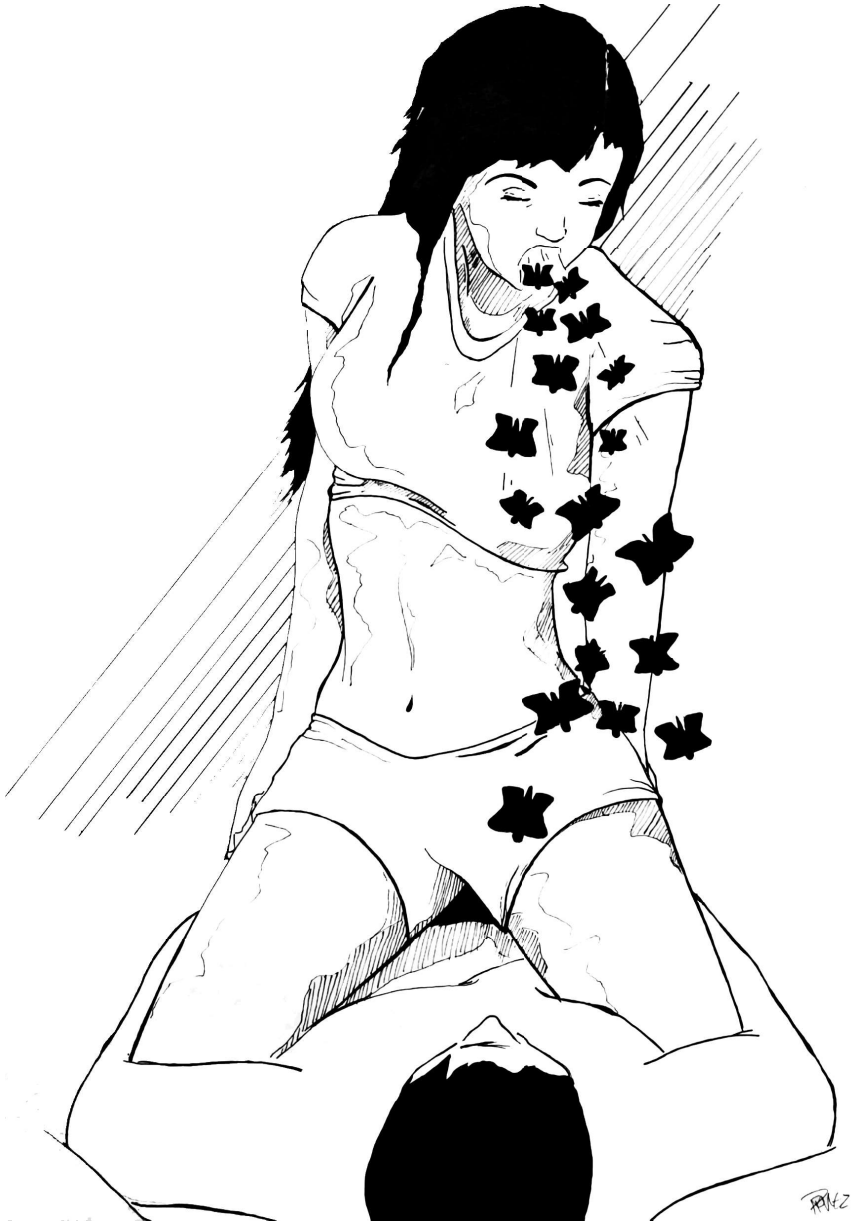
the only child & must care for
my health. side effects develop
every day: lately, an allergy
to certain kinds of squash,
a kink where i pretend
to be the Gerber
baby lolling
in a home
theater.

ii.

the vitamins are shaped like dinosaurs
to make them palatable. i don't know how
shape affects flavor but when i
think of extinction
i taste less
gunmetal.

iii.

i've come to
imagine my body
as a capsule.
i peel the
shine away
& my insides
look like ash.



BATON ROUGE ALTERNATIVE

ZINE 2 - DECEMBER 2018

Virginia

<< An ivory man, bronzed by the sun. He came to me from the Virginia commonwealth. Is he a southern gentleman or a northern man? Perhaps, We the People, shall never agree. >>
These thoughts of poetics race through my life, race for the finish line, as my heart races on my way to the top of a cinderblock, granite palace consumed by pages of literature, pages of a paradise that was lost. A hermit in his own cave of intellectual writing surely is waiting for me. The cave is dimly lit. The walls match the colors of my once-dishwater-blonde-hair. The air waltzes with the scent of espresso beans and mildew that is hiding deep within the walls, hoping to never be found, hoping to be left at peace. Your favorite word, what was it again? Didactic. Didactic. Didactic. I finally learned the meaning. I hiked all this way to tell you, to find you through Spanish moss and windmills, through leaves of grass and thread spinners, through little blonde girls with wagons and silently strong men harvesting crops, through the sacredly old and wrinkled maps of Benito Cereno and a Pequod whaler. Yes, I hiked up to find you, but you moved down a flight, to a brightly-lit marble deck, but up in life, is not that right? The clink clink clink of my worn-out boots echoes through the fibers of my blood and my being as I hike up this unforgivably steep mountain to your cave of scholarly wonders. The passing of others swallows the air as they go down the mountain, while I go up, but right now, I am choosing to only hear jaggedly sharp mountains of silence, allowing the void to encumber the spaces between sinfully steep mountains of structurally sustainable minerals extracted from the earth at the hands of man. Nabokov said he wrote Her for Véra, but only you and Lolita were made for such perfectly scandalous lines. I have what feels like epochs of time to ponder every page of writing you have suffocated me with, as I climb up this blacker-than-tar-baby mountain. The further from the ground I climb, the more the smell of ordinary things change into a dingy depression cherry memory. Decay in the structure of the mountain's walls say hello and good day, water droplets of metallic taste dance on my shoulders and the tip of my breath, the echo of my boots clink clink clink and permeate the doors of your dungeon-like cave. I used to make this trip more often than not—several times every week for two entire rotations of the Sun just to complete my lessons with you, through the smell of dust and mold; through the sickly, sweet aroma of honey buns and the



DG: What has kept you in Baton Rouge?

JF: I don't know. I guess it's comfortable. I've lived other places The last time I cam back I met my wife and had kids. I'm kind of a sucker for a lost cause so I'm going down with the ship. Baton Rouge I don't think is ever going to be very progessive and we'll always, just like we did back in the day, we had our little bohemian society. You have it now too and I guess I'm just like the old guard somewhat of it.

DG: What are you hoping to accomplish with The Exchange and The Ballroom?

JF: I want to have a cool store where people can come. I'd like to put Baton Rouge a little bit more on the map and make it a little bit more of a stopping place for touring bands. It was back then. It was up until fairly recently, 10-15 years ago. Bands would stop in. We had Gas Food Lodging Fest, people going to and from Austin, South by Southwest. The Music Exchange is a part of that, but my purpose of The Ballroom, which I'm working on now. We're going to do more and step up the game. [The Ballroom's purpose] is to have those mid-level touring bands come play here and get local support. [They'll] have the local bands open it up so more people than just the little society here can see the local music and maybe open their minds to more stuff.

DG: Any advice for future generations?

JF: No. I have no advice for future generations. Just be cool. Everybody be cool to each other. That's it.

dusty funk of graphite lodged between pieces of wood. You, my magical guide, constantly hovering over my exhausted and insatiable intellect, interrogating me, torturing me until my spine finally breaks during our interrogation sessions. "What does it mean to be an American?" You hound at me, but all I can answer through my bloody cries is

I do not know

but that was then, and this is now, and right now—it has been months since I have made my trip up to that Magnolia and Oleander leaves mountain. I have tried to pretend that everything was colored with a rosy, acrylic scent and looked as lovely and as shiny as the pigments of a cloy cherry, not the black and blue bruises of my festering depression, but that's simply just not true. It's funny—how I try to convince myself that I hate South Sea Narratives, how I try to convince myself that I hate Melville, how I try to convince myself that I actually hate you, but that's simply just not true. It's funny—how Milton made a Catholic school girl resent and yet love her holy God from above, how I was once an aspiring-medical-doctor turned hopeful-doctor-of-books who so girlishly loved an aspiring-medical-doctor-turned-about-to-be-doctor-of-books who lives inside a dimly lit cave in a House of Usher, fallen Camelot mountain. When his dungeon shakes, will he allow his chains to fall off? I have delivered the hermit documents of my misfortunate health. The messages produced by the psychoanalysts and licensed, clinical social workers of my life speak parallel volumes of an 1852 New York Day Book Melville critique. We no longer believe in headlines titled "HERMAN MELVILLE CRAZY," because that's simply just not true, only headlines titled "MISS BARNETT CRAZY," because that simply just is. I reminiscence on my literary past, my literary present, and my literary future. I love how way leads on to way. I so deeply miss my journeys up that decrepit, ravaged by loneliness mountain.

I miss my pain so much that I often wonder if I will ever go back.

New Local



"Tentative Power" is Hal Lambert's first release. It is a 10 track ablum recorded, mixed and mastered by Hal Lambert, except for track 1, reorded by Jake Heflin (of Wumbo).

Buy it at one of his shows or by contacting him at tentative.power@gmail.com

Experimental/free guitar
September 2018



"Nothing, Nothing, Nothing" is a recurring zine published by Emily Jean McCollister. It features the work of six poets and an interview.

Buy it at Southside Arts Center, located at 524 N Foster Dr.

Various
September 2018



"Nothing, Nothing, Nothing" is a recurring zine published by Emily Jean McCollister. This zine is made for kids and features the works of five poets and artists.

Buy it at Southside Arts Center, located at 524 N Foster Dr.

Various
October 2018

with James Fogle

DG: What was the punk scene like back then in Baton Rouge? I hear it was pretty strong.

JF: I guess it was pretty strong, but like I said, there was one place where most of the punk bands played. We would get some gigs at The Chimes sometimes. They had a place called The Gumbo Place that would have some punk shows on Chimes Street then futher down Chimes Street they had a place called Combined Effort and they would have shows in there. I'd say it was pretty strong. There wasn't like ten thousand people hanging around. It was the same people; kind of like the way it is now. It was the same bohemian group of people in Baton Rouge, so we were about as bohemian as you can be for Baton Rouge. It was either Chimes Street - The Bayou at the end of Chimes Street. It was either Chimes Stree or Jacys. There were lots of shows at Jacys all the time. All week long. All the touring punk bands cames through and played there and played New Orleans. We played New Orleans a whole lot too. There was a good punk scene in New Orleans. We would generally play at Jacys one weekend, and a lot of times the band playing at Jacys would invite us to go play at Jed's. [Jed's] was the punk club in New Orleans on Oak Street and we'd go play with them. We'd do Friday night here and Saturday night over there or vice versa. So there was stuff to do. Lots of bands playing. Lots of things going on.

A SHORT HISTORY OF LOCAL MUSIC

James Fogle is the owner and operator of Baton Rouge Music Exchange, which buys, sells, trades, and repairs music gear and instruments. He also owns and operates Mid City Ballroom, a music venue that hosts many local music events. He has been a part of the Baton Rouge music community since the mid 80s, playing in various bands of various genres.

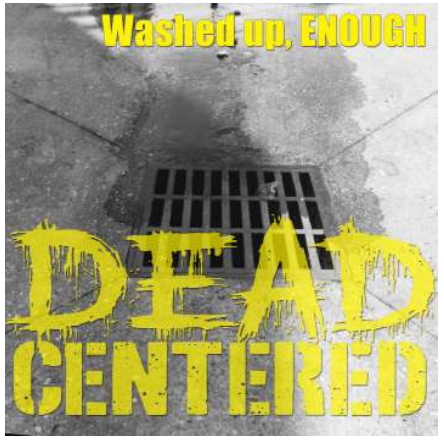
DG: What were some of your early music projects?

JF: We were in a little heavy metal band called Invaders. We did a bunch of covers of hair metal bands and stuff like that. That was probably the first thing.

DG: When was that?

JF: The mid 80s, when I was 16 or 17. From there, a friend of mine introduced me to one of my best friends, John Sanchez who is a great guitar player and songwriter. He lives in Austin now, but he's from here. He started a punk band called Mind Hat. We had a couple of practices, all original songs and we opened up for The Agnostic Front at Jacys, which is The Red Dragon now. That was the punk rock club. That was my introduction to that. They were shaving everybody's heads and going crazy and I'm like, 'Wow, this is nuts.' We played at Fest For All and almost got thrown off the stage because they didn't really dig what we were saying and doing. They didn't really know we were that kind of band. We weren't like a crazy punk band, but we had some controversial things. We ended up changing our name to 'Reagan's Bastard Children.'

RELEASES



"Washed up, Enough" is Deadcentered's second release. It is an eight track album recorded, mixed, and mastered by Studio Dudio.

Buy it at one of their shows.

Heavy Thrash/ Aggressive Hardcore Punk RocknRoll
December 2018



"Over" is Wonder Kid's first release. It is a five track EP recorded and mixed by Max Stratmann (of Wonder Kid). It was mastered by Mike Kalajian (of Rogue Planet Mastering).

Buy it at one of their shows or at bandcamp.com. Listen on any major online platform.

MopeVVave or indie/emo/noise rock
November 2018



"The Night Shift" is 9th Life's first release. It is a nine track album recorded, mixed, and mastered at Swiger Studio by Matthew Urquhart (of Loudness War) and Joe Swiger.

Buy or listen to it through any major online platform.

Hip-hop
October 2018

"split ends" is a fine art photography zine by Lily LaGrange comprised of artwork from her BFA thesis exhibition.

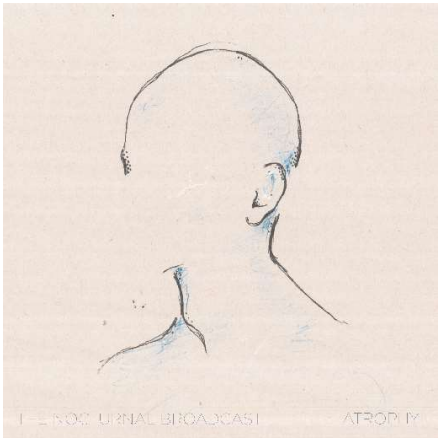
Photography
November 2018



"Atrophy" is The Nocturnal Broadcast's second release. It is a three track ep, recorded at Dead Horse Studios. Mixing, mastering by Mike Desmond.

Listen to it on any major online platform.

Indie/Alt-emo
October 2018



leaves a much smaller percentage of people for original bands in the scene to target to. That being said, while our scene can feel niche, the people that do support the scene and go out to shows are really inspiring. I don't think we've ever had it easy here, and there is a comradely that has grown from that in a way- a sense of pride for sticking to our guns. We're not afraid to shout out loud that we do what we do and we love it!

DG: What advice would you give someone starting to become more involved in the Baton Rouge music scene?

CH: Network of course for starters...if you want the media to pay attention to you, you have to be willing to reach out to the editors and journalists that are currently hitting the beat. Don't sit and wait for them to come to you because it's probable that with all of the activity going on around town you will get overlooked. Once you get an article or two under your belt, your credibility can really benefit and moving forward you will find it easier to get coverage of your shows, releases, etc... Also, like Davy and others here with BR alternative and 524, don't be afraid to get out and get your hands dirty! DIY baby. If you want the scene to change for the better, you need to get out there and BE that change. Reach out for help at times. There are plenty of local graphic designers, website programmers, artists, photographers, journalists, and music enthusiasts around that often are willing to help out musicians just because they love being involved with the scene. You'd be amazed at what can come of just making a FB post asking for advice or recommendations. Likewise, support the bands and artists that you see trying to make things happen. It will only reflect back in your direction, and local artists are always grateful for feedback and attention!

I ran on Tom Dr. The scene was really booming in those years and every show just felt like such a victory in terms of crowd size but also because there was such a strong feeling of teamwork present. We would have label parties and everyone from every band in town would get to hang and connect. The feeling was definitely magnetic that if we stuck together, we could all go somewhere. Sad to say it was beyond just me to keep the propulsion of that attitude going forever and politics happen. I was young and it was certainly a humbling experience to say the least. I'm just proud to say that I got to contribute to our city and it's musical history, even if in a small way!

DG: What have been some of the most difficult struggles you've faced when it comes to being a successful part of the Baton Rouge music scene?

CH: There have been so many... no big secret that there is a lot of love for cover bands here, and while I have nothing but respect for badass musicians that can memorize 2,000 songs and play 2 hour sets to make some real dough- I think we are over saturated and the side effects hit original bands in unintended ways. The traditions and expectations for late night music are just straight up different here than in other major "music" cities like Seattle, Portland, Austin. So much of the 18-23 year old crowd in BR (our target show attending demographic) comes from LSU and we have this notorious reputation for being party animals, so a huge chunk of potential show goers are going out at night with other ambitions and want to be where their friends are at. Frat bars and clubs get a lot of attention, and that



AN INTERVIEW

Raegan Labat is the founder and operator of Tough Gum, which publishes photo diarys of various diy communities and organizes original live music events such as Warfair, mentioned below.

DG: What drove you to start documenting musicians and producing local shows?

RL: Well, my start of documenting musicians started as early as picking up a camera for real. Maybe 8th or 9th grade? Once I was old enough and started taking interest in going to see live music frequently, that's when I also started documenting it. I would literally wait at festival gates to open, so that I could be front row for a performer that I wanted to photograph. This is before I even knew about the world of media passes. I also used to email 18+ venues just on the off chance they would let me in. Ha! They never did. But, that's how I started. I had to make it work. I've photographed music ever since, though, which somehow eventually lead me to producing my own shows from time to time. Curating my own shows gives me the opportunity to book music that I love, show people what I love, document what I love and be apart of the whole dang experience. I really do just love championing the artists I admire and want to support.

DG: What is your annual event, Warfair all about? What is its overall goal?

RL: Man, oh man. My first festival. WarFair was dreamed up by my boyfriend Ryan and myself one day while walking the LSU lakes. We were

WITH COHEN HARTMAN

Cohen & The Ghost, a band I was in from 2007-2011. We knew absolutely nothing about proper technique regarding production...We just threw mics up and focused on making music and having fun. My grandfather showed me the basics of tracking in Pro Tools and from there it's been a long journey!

DG: What have been some of your proudest contributions to the Baton Rouge music scene?

CH: Definitely the short-lived but (hopefully) memorable DIY label, Phantom Party Records, that myself and a few other local musicians formed and ran from 2008-2011. Just before I started it with Derek Arbour of Silky Screens, I had been booking so many shows all over with my band (the ghost) that I had established a strong network among venues, media outlets, and musicians around BR. I figured I could use these contacts and reputation to help book and handle promotion for other up and coming bands that maybe didn't have as much of a foot in the door. It started off exactly like that but grew quickly and soon me and the PP crew were booking shows for our artists almost every weekend, in and around the city. We had some of the best local bands in the history of BR on board (IMO) including England In 1819, Prom Date, He Bleeds Fireman, Gypsy Space Caravan, The Mysterious Stranger, and for a time Royal Teeth which went on to see a good bit of mainstream success. Many other bands came and went too, and I got to often record and even co-write songs with most of them at my studio

AN INTERVIEW

Cohen Hartman is the singer/songwriter for local band, Neon Mountain. In the late 2000s and early 2010s, he lead groups such as Cohen and the Ghost (band) and Phantom Party Records (label), both very important to the local indie community.

DG: What drove you to start writing and producing music?

CH: I goofed around writing songs in elementary school with my friends but never took it seriously until I got into records like Weezer's "Pinkerton", "Kid A", Elliott Smith's "Either/Or" and Pink Floyd's "The Wall" around when I was 13. From there inspiration grew and some key songwriters of the mid 2000's like Oberst, Kasher, Win Butler, and Thom Yorke definitely propelled me further as I started finally being able to handle myself on guitar enough to get ideas out. As far as production, I was lucky in my early teens to have had access to my grandfather's south LA recording studio whenever I wanted. He used to record zydeco bands from all over and had all this top notch studio gear in a room attached to his house. Mountains of instruments...like literally dozens of guitars, basses, violins, accordions, mandolins, banjos, keyboards, amps, microphones, drum sets, accessories, etc... I used to go down for the weekend or sometimes a whole week at a time and try to complete a record in whatever time I had. I would stay up until all hours of the night, often with good friends and other musicians, experimenting with whatever gear we dug up. A lot of these friends became later members of

WITH RAEGAN LABAT

bored and anxious to do something creative and probably talking about how cool other cities are because of all of these different festivals we like to go to. So, we decided to start a festival! Tough Gum and Ryan's band Loudness War host it. What started as a house party in Ryan's backyard now sees 200+ people at a local venue. Ideally, WarFair celebrates this alternative music scene and talented artists that are a little out of the box for the city. I guess alternative is a bit broad, but we do have a vision. We wanted punk, garage, art, experimental and really anyone doing something a little different or exciting to have this big spotlight on them just for a night. We also really wanted to bring bands we love into Baton Rouge's scene- kind of as a way to inspire people. So, we really try our best to make WarFair this big thing because we believe 100% in elevating these bands and certain sounds. We try and book local acts that really stand out to us and then bring in regional and out-of-town bands that really excite and impress us. WarFair 3 is going to be the biggest and best. I'm so thrilled to be able to do this with a team of friends. WarFair 3 is Saturday, December 8 at Mid City Ballroom.

DG: What have been some of the biggest hardships you've faced while operating Tough Gum?

RL: Well, Tough Gum started as a way for me to file all of these random things I do under one place. I can definitely take the time to acknowledge that there are other people doing

things constantly and consistently in the music scene and that this is a side project for me. Tough Gum is operated when I can or feel like I need to, and maybe that's the hardship? Staying focused. Tough Gum was and is a test for all of the things I like to do. I make photos, I book shows, I help throw a fest, I make playlists, I interview bands, I promote new music, and more. Maybe my hardship is that Tough Gum is a file of all these random things- so what is it that I really truly want to do and how do I want to contribute to the music scene? Tough Gum is just a collage of things of me figuring it out and doing what I love or feel like doing.

DG: What advice would you give someone starting to become more involved in the Baton Rouge music scene?

RL: Do what you love and really go for it. I think Baton Rouge is really good at not just promoting a "music scene," but promoting this community that is eager to support local artists, promoters, creative friends, photographers, etc, etc. Sometimes, as a creative, you can get really down on yourself or unmotivated... surprisingly Baton Rouge helps with that because this city really can be just so welcoming. Just try anything.

